

ombud.

Every citizen deserves someone who reads the fine print for them.

THE PROBLEM

Bureaucracies were built to be fair. *Treating everyone the same in a system no one can read* is not fairness — it is exclusion by paperwork.

If you can decode the form, you get the benefit. If you can't, you don't. The system works best for the people who need it least.

FOUR SCENES, REPEATED DAILY

What goes wrong.

AT THE DMV

You are sent home. One document was missing, and no one told you that until you reached the counter.

AT THE COURTHOUSE

You miss a deadline. The instructions were written for lawyers, and you are not one.

AT THE HOSPITAL

You sign consent. You did not understand what you were consenting to, and no one was asked to check.

AT HOME, IN THE MAIL

Your Medicaid lapses. The renewal letter arrived in English. Your household reads Vietnamese.

THE SOLUTION

A digital bureaucratic advocate *for everyone.*

ombud sits between a person and an institution. It explains in plain language, checks that your documents are in order, and routes you through the system in real time. It does not replace the clerk, the doctor, or the judge — it gives every citizen the quiet advantage that a well-connected family already has.

EXPLAINS

Policy and jargon in plain language.

CHECKS

Documents and eligibility before you submit.

ROUTES

The right line, form, and deadline in order.

THE COMPANION

Meet your *ombuddy*.

Every domain has its own ombuddy — domain-specific, rule-aware, patient. It knows the forms, the deadlines, and the failure modes. It speaks the user's language, literally and otherwise. It does not hurry you. It does not make you feel small for not knowing.

Available in 20+ languages, by voice or text, online or offline.

• DMV OMBUDDY • EN ESPAÑOL

¿Necesito traer mi pasaporte para la Real ID?

OMBUDDY

Sí. Para la Real ID necesitas un pasaporte vigente, dos comprobantes de domicilio y tu tarjeta del Seguro Social. He revisado tu cita: falta el segundo comprobante. Te envió la lista ahora.

¿Cuánto voy a esperar?

OMBUDDY

Tu número es el **B-47**. Quedan 12 personas antes — unos 28 minutos. Te aviso cuando falten cinco.

THE ARCHITECTURE

Four verbs. *That is the whole product.*

01

Explain

Policy, jargon, and legal language rendered in plain, local speech.

02

Check

Documents, eligibility, and status audited before you waste the trip.

03

Route

Which window, which form, which deadline — in the correct order.

04

Log

Every interaction recorded, exportable, auditable. Nothing gets lost.

DMV & Transportation.

Guides visitors through registration, licensing, and ID — so the line only happens once.

WHAT CHANGES

- 01 Missing documents caught before you leave the house.
- 02 Real-time routing — the right counter, the right order.
- 03 Multilingual support, so language is not a filter.
- 04 Clerks do less translation; satisfaction metrics get measured.

SPOTLIGHT · 02 / 04

Hospital & Patient.

Walks patients through intake, consent, and aftercare — with comprehension confirmed, not assumed.

WHAT CHANGES

- 01 Informed consent means informed — comprehension checked in plain language.
- 02 Aftercare instructions the patient can actually follow.
- 03 Nurses repeat themselves less; patients stay oriented and calm.
- 04 Every consent logged, signed, auditable.

SPOTLIGHT · 03 / 04

Court & Legal Clerk.

Helps self-represented citizens file motions, pay fines, and meet deadlines — without a lawyer at their elbow.

WHAT CHANGES

- 01 Procedure explained clearly; correct forms suggested on the spot.
- 02 Deadlines tracked — fewer procedural dismissals.
- 03 Legal definitions on demand, in the language of the user.
- 04 Courthouse congestion falls; access to justice rises.

Housing & Tenant.

Landlords have lawyers. Tenants have Google. A leveler for the process the law already describes.

WHAT CHANGES

- 01 Legal rights explained; dispute letters generated.
- 02 Deadlines tracked; wrongful evictions prevented.
- 03 Escalation to legal aid when a case needs a human.
- 04 Power dynamics brought back into balance.

Everywhere a person meets an institution.

28 DOMAINS · AND COUNTING

01 <i>DMV & Transportation</i>	02 <i>Hospital & Patient</i>	03 <i>Court & Legal</i>	04 Public Defender	05 Immigration
06 Probation & Reintegration	07 Parent & K-12 Education	08 University & Student	09 Research & Lab	10 Unemployment & Job Center
11 Corporate HR & Workplace	12 Small Business & Licensing	13 Financial & Credit	14 Medicaid & Medicare	15 Elder Care
16 Disability & Accessibility	17 <i>Housing & Tenant</i>	18 Public Utilities	19 Building & Zoning	20 Transportation & Traveler
21 Refugee & Humanitarian	22 Indigenous Services	23 Homeless & Street	24 Reentry & Ex-Incarcerated	25 Insurance
26 Pharmacy & Medication	27 Clinical Trial	28 Municipal & Civic		

THE PLATFORM

Built once. Configured for each domain.

The architecture is the same everywhere. A new domain is a configuration problem, not an engineering project.

01 — LANGUAGE

Plain-language explanation

Translates policy, jargon, and legal text into local, spoken language — at the reading level of the user.

02 — ACCESS

Multilingual & multimodal

Voice, text, online, offline. 20+ languages at launch. Low-literacy and assistive paths by default.

03 — PROCESS

Documents & deadlines

Checks eligibility, audits paperwork, tracks renewals, and sends reminders before things fall off.

04 — STATUS

Real-time routing

Which line, which window, which form, which officer — updated live as the system moves.

05 — RECORD

Auditable log

Every explanation, consent, and submission recorded and exportable. Nothing can be denied later.

06 — RULEPACKS

Open domain standards

Each domain's rules ship as an open rulepack — auditable, forkable, reviewable by the public.

ALIGNMENT

Three groups. *One clean win.*

FOR CITIZENS

Clarity, dignity, outcomes.

Access to the benefits, rights, and services the system already promised them — without needing a lawyer, a cousin at the agency, or a good day.

FOR INSTITUTIONS

Shorter lines, cleaner records.

Fewer repeat visits, fewer call-center hours, fewer procedural dismissals. Staff do the work they were trained for. The audit trail is built in.

FOR THE PUBLIC

A system that works.

The quiet, civic feeling of institutions that function. Trust isn't earned by a slogan. It's earned by the forty-seventh interaction, not the first.

WHAT WE WILL NOT COMPROMISE ON

Principles.

I. Plain language is non-negotiable. If the user doesn't understand it, it isn't done.

III. Never hide the human. The ombuddy makes the path to a clerk, lawyer, or nurse shorter — never longer.

V. Accessible by default. Voice, text, offline, low-literacy, 20+ languages. Not a later release.

II. The user's data belongs to the user. Exportable, portable, deletable, always.

IV. Every interaction logged. So nothing gets lost, and nothing can be quietly denied later.

VI. Rulepacks are open. The rules of a public system should be readable by the public.

ROADMAP

Where we go next.

NOW • THREE PILOTS

A city DMV, a county court, a regional hospital.

Live deployments against real queues, real filings, real consents. We harden the platform against the institutions hardest to move.

NEXT • PLATFORM & RULEPACKS

Open the first five rulepacks.

Publish the domain rules as auditable open standards. Make the system forkable, reviewable, and cheap for another municipality to adopt.

LATER • THE FULL MAP

Onboard every domain that meets a citizen.

Twenty-seven and counting. The goal is boring and serious: make bureaucracy legible for everyone, everywhere.

THE ASK

Three things.

The point of a public service is to serve the public. If you believe that, come find us.

Pilots.

Agencies and institutions willing to run a real deployment — courts, clinics, housing authorities, DMVs.

Funding.

To build out the platform and ship the first five open rulepacks over the next eighteen months.

Advocates.

People inside institutions who believe a public service exists to serve the public. We need you.